FATAL FALL FROM HORSE

Chippenham Major's Death

Mr. Thomas Edwards described to the Oxford Coroner on Monday how his employer, Major Patrick Leatham, M.C., who farmed at Seagry Manor, Chippenham, fell from a horse on to his head after the animal had reared and bucked for about 20 yards.

The major, late of the Tenth Hussars, died after two operations. The accident occurred near his home. A verdict of death by misadventure was recorded.

Mr. Edwards said the Major kept five horses and was an experienced rider. When he rode the horse out to the Major it behaved normally.

Dr. J. C. F. Poole, pathologist, said that Major Leatham died from concussion, laceration of the brain and a skull fracture. No operation could have saved him.

Service at Seagry

The village church of St. Mary's, Seagry, was packed to capacity on Wednesday afternoon for the memorial service for Major Leatham.

In his address the Rural Dean, the Rev. W. H. Barkwell (rector of Christian Malford), who officiated—being assisted by the Rev. Llewellyn Lewis, of Little Somerford, priest in charge—referred to the second tragedy which had befallen Seagry in so short a time. The Rev. Barkwell also spoke of the deep interest shown by Major Leatham in all the affairs of the village. He was people's warden, and in the last war served with great gallantry, having been wounded on three occasions, and was the holder of the Military Cross. At the organ, Mr. P. Selwood played for the hymns "Love Divine" and "Jesus Lives," also Psalm 23, and the Benedictus. The lesson was read by Mr. E. C. Barnes.